# Vitiligo

Understanding pigment loss and protecting sensitive areas of skin

**ABOUT THIS TOPIC**

Vitiligo causes patches of skin to lose pigment. It is not contagious. Other conditions can also cause pale patches, so a clinician should confirm the diagnosis and discuss whether treatment is appropriate.

## Everyday care and treatment

- Use sun protection on lighter patches: shade, protective clothing, and broad-spectrum SPF 30 or higher sunscreen.
- Avoid skin injury and sunburn. Do not try strong bleaching products or unverified remedies.
- Treatment options vary and may include prescription creams, light therapy, or other specialist care. They can take time and may not restore all pigment.
- Discuss effects on confidence or wellbeing with a health professional; support is part of care.

**WHEN TO GET HELP**

Arrange assessment for new or changing pale patches, especially if the diagnosis is uncertain. Ask a dermatologist about options, expected benefits, risks, and realistic timelines.

## Sources for further reading

American Academy of Dermatology - Vitiligo treatment - https://www.aad.org/public/diseases/a-z/vitiligo-treatment

Reviewed for this educational handout: October 2026. Recommendations can change and depend on local guidance, age, pregnancy, other health conditions, and medicines. This handout is not a diagnosis or prescription.